

AMERICAS INVESTMENT BANKS

Structural M&A growth persists, but expenses continue to rise, with valuation upside less likely; key themes exiting 2Q26 EPS

Independent investment bank (IBank) stocks fell ~2% on average since the day before the first 2Q26 IBank EPS print (7/22/26),¹ underperforming the S&P 500 by 5pp, driven largely by estimate downgrades, on: 1) concerns that there could be an M&A air pocket in 2H26; 2) uneven M&A trends across peers; and 3) a 1% median earnings miss (marking the first time in ~4+ years IBanks missed EPS for two consecutive quarters), driven by higher expenses than expected. All in, we believe that at the midpoint of the cycle, the M&A growth path remains strong for the group, with several years of M&A growth left. We shift our preference to sponsor and mid-cap (<\$10bn deal size) M&A from large-cap, strategic M&A. We view these as likely to have stronger growth from here off of a low base and in light of structural tailwinds, whereas the second derivative of large-cap & strategic M&A could turn negative. We see IBanks' operating leverage path as increasingly challenged, after lowering pre-tax margins for 2026E-28E by 10-25bps vs. pre-EPS, given much greater non-comp spend than previously

contemplated. Finally, as we are mid-cycle, we see less rerating potential - IBank multiples typically peak early cycle. Thus, stock performance appears set to be largely driven by EPS revisions. We highlight three key 2H26 themes: 1) how much strategic/large-cap M&A can grow from an already strong level, vs. potential acceleration in sponsor/mid-cap M&A; 2) the ability for growth to continue after years of robust non-M&A advisory growth, specifically within secondaries and restructuring; and 3) mounting questions around structural negative operating leverage, driven by both heavier comp and non-comp spend. YTD, industry announced M&A volumes are up ~40% YoY, driven by large-cap/strategic M&A strength (up ~80%/55% YTD YoY), vs. more tepid mid-cap/sponsor M&A (up ~30%/5%). 2Q26 restructuring was down 1% YoY, and 1H26 secondaries volume rose 19% YoY. The group trades at a ~16.0x average NTM P/E (on GSe), or a ~60th %ile multiple² over the past decade.

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¹ Excluding JEF which has a fiscal year different from calendar year.

² Note: We exclude LCLN to calculate %ile given a short time period since its IPO.

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Top picks: Given our shifting views on growth areas within M&A, we prefer firms that can benefit from a mid-cap & sponsor acceleration, specifically Buy-rated **LCLN** and **PIPR**, and those that offer structural growth, and can benefit from continued non-M&A growth, specifically Buy-rated **EVR** and **PJT**.

Exhibit 1: Median IBank earnings came in 1% below consensus, driven by 15bps lower operating margins, with a significant bifurcation on trends across IBanks

Total Revenue (%)					Expenses (%)					Total MD count (%)				
Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons	Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons	Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons
EVR	-29%	19%	-1%	1%	EVR	-23%	19%	1%	2%	EVR	3%	18%	3%	2%
HLI	-20%	-16%	-18%	-16%	HLI	-15%	-11%	-15%	-13%	HLI	4%	7%	0%	-
LAZ	17%	2%	5%	7%	LAZ	16%	9%	8%	10%	LAZ	-5%	11%	-6%	-
LCLN	43%	51%	33%	33%	LCLN	37%	46%	24%	23%	LCLN	1%	1%	0%	0%
MC	28%	12%	4%	6%	MC	21%	10%	5%	6%	MC	2%	5%	1%	0%
PJT	16%	20%	14%	14%	PJT	14%	16%	11%	12%	PJT**	1%	10%	0%	-
PWP	5%	1%	-2%	8%	PWP	-16%	-7%	-10%	-6%	PWP	-16%	5%	2%	-
PIPR	5%	21%	7%	10%	PIPR	2%	16%	5%	7%	PIPR	1%	6%	-1%	-
JEF	7%	35%	0%	-3%	JEF	5%	26%	0%	-1%	JEF	-	-	-	-
FCN	1%	5%	-1%	0%	FCN	0%	7%	-1%	0%	FCN	-	-	-	-
Median	6%	16%	2%	6%	Median	3%	13%	3%	4%	Median	1%	6%	-	-
Advisory revenue (%)					Comp ratio (bps)					Non-Comp Ratio (bps)				
Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons	Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons	Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons
EVR	-38%	11%	-3%	-1%	EVR	-51bp	-190bp	-47bp	-69bp	EVR	682bp	165bp	168bp	124bp
HLI	-20%	-16%	-18%	-16%	HLI	-5bp	-5bp	-5bp	-7bp	HLI	475bp	396bp	294bp	239bp
LAZ	25%	-9%	6%	9%	LAZ	-5bp	438bp	238bp	321bp	LAZ	-26bp	139bp	-25bp	-50bp
LCLN	62%	56%	39%	39%	LCLN	-45bp	262bp	5bp	69bp	LCLN	-279bp	-525bp	-563bp	-742bp
MC	28%	12%	4%	6%	MC	0bp	-320bp	5bp	3bp	MC	-478bp	183bp	55bp	3bp
PJT	16%	20%	14%	14%	PJT	0bp	-101bp	-1bp	7bp	PJT	-167bp	-103bp	-181bp	-177bp
PWP	5%	1%	-2%	8%	PWP	-1549bp	-387bp	-262bp	-583bp	PWP	-506bp	-337bp	-423bp	-635bp
PIPR	9%	34%	7%	9%	PIPR	-10bp	-50bp	-10bp	-16bp	PIPR	-171bp	-321bp	-189bp	-206bp
JEF	28%	47%	0%	-1%	JEF	33bp	194bp	39bp	87bp	JEF	-61bp	-760bp	0bp	139bp
FCN	0%	2%	-	-	FCN	-	-	-	-	FCN	-	-	-	-
Median	13%	12%	4%	8%	Median	-5bp	-50bp	-1bp	3bp	Median	-167bp	-103bp	-25bp	-50bp
Operating Margin (bps)					EPS (%)					Capital Return (bps)				
Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons	Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons	Ticker	QoQ	YoY	vs. GSe	vs. Cons
EVR	-632bp	25bp	-121bp	-55bp	EVR	-61%	20%	-7%	-4%	EVR	-464bp	30bp	-	-
HLI	-470bp	-391bp	-289bp	-232bp	HLI	-17%	-37%	-24%	-18%	HLI	-4bp	5bp	-	-
LAZ	30bp	-577bp	-213bp	-271bp	LAZ	-72%	-77%	-65%	-65%	LAZ	-105bp	-85bp	-	-
LCLN	460bp	33bp	665bp	761bp	LCLN	-	-	82%	98%	LCLN	-	-	-	-
MC	478bp	137bp	-60bp	-6bp	MC	26%	18%	-4%	1%	MC	209bp	254bp	-	-
PJT	167bp	204bp	182bp	169bp	PJT	28%	28%	26%	26%	PJT	486bp	34bp	-	-
PWP	2055bp	724bp	685bp	1219bp	PWP	294%	122%	81%	266%	PWP	413bp	-564bp	-	-
PIPR	181bp	371bp	199bp	222bp	PIPR	4%	41%	14%	18%	PIPR	334bp	47bp	-	-
JEF	28bp	566bp	0bp	-226bp	JEF	0%	111%	0%	-20%	JEF	243bp	181bp	-	-
FCN	69bp	-129bp	-69bp	-19bp	FCN	5%	-7%	-18%	-12%	FCN	80bp	-87bp	-	-
Median	118bp	85bp	-30bp	-13bp	Median	4%	20%	-2%	-1%	Median	209bp	30bp	-	-

Note: Capital return is yield (i.e., relative to market cap); PJT** MD count includes M&A and Restructuring; HLI/PJT advisory revenue = total revenue; for PJT and JEF, we use pre-tax margins; LAZ MDs are advisory only.

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Three key themes

1. Is strategic/large-cap M&A close to peak levels, and can sponsor/small & mid-cap improve more broadly? Best positioned: **HLI, JEF, LCLN**.

- a. **Strategic/large-cap M&A:** We see an increasing likelihood that growth in large-cap and strategic M&A could slow from currently elevated levels. YTD announced strategic/large-cap M&A volumes are up ~55%/80% YoY, and up ~100%/235% from the recent cyclical trough (in 2023-24) on an annualized basis ([Exhibit 2](#), [Exhibit 3](#), [Exhibit 6](#), [Exhibit 7](#)). YTD annualized levels are 20%/50% above all-time historical annual peaks. Strategic/large-cap volumes are at 4.5%/2.2% of global equal weight market-cap, which compare to 6.3%/2.0% on average over the past 17 years - large-cap market cap-weighted M&A volumes are above the long-term average for the first time since 2020 ([Exhibit 8](#), [Exhibit 9](#)). Further, the average M&A transaction deal size is up 30% YoY, and sponsor M&A is only ~26% of YTD announced M&A volumes, vs. 35%/32% trailing 5-yr/10-yr average ([Exhibit 5](#), [Exhibit 4](#)). We believe much of the strength in large-cap and strategic M&A has been due to corporates taking advantage of a less aggressive US antitrust enforcement posture, with growth from here likely driven by whether strategics feel a yet greater urgency to act before this US presidential administration ends.
- b. **Sponsor/mid-cap M&A:** We become increasingly optimistic on sponsor/mid-cap M&A growth accelerating. Sponsor M&A volumes have been muted, driven by a valuation disconnect between buyers and sellers, with assets acquired when rates were materially lower. However, we see volumes rise as LP pressure mounts on GPs, and not that sponsors remain an area of structural growth. Mid-cap M&A has not taken off nearly as much as large-cap M&A, given the lack of an antitrust impulse to conduct transactions, with volumes more heavily impacted by negative geopolitical and macro trends. YTD announced sponsor/mid-cap M&A volumes are up only ~5%/30% YoY, and up 65%/57% from the recent cyclical trough on an annualized basis ([Exhibit 2](#), [Exhibit 3](#), [Exhibit 10](#), [Exhibit 11](#)). YTD annualized levels remain ~30%/20% below all-time historical annual peaks. Further, sponsor/mid-cap volumes are at 2.1%/4.4% of global equal weight market-cap, which compare to 2.5%/7.4% on average over the past 17 years - in particular, mid-cap market cap-weighted M&A volumes remain near the low over the past 17 years ([Exhibit 12](#), [Exhibit 13](#)). That being said, we see early signs of an inflection, with June/July 2026 sponsor M&A volumes up ~20%/33% YoY. Further, structural PE M&A drivers remain, namely large \$s of aged, deployed capital that needs to be returned, and large quantities of uncommitted capital that need to be deployed. Consider that sponsor M&A fees have grown by ~1400% since 2001, vs. strategic fees have risen ~125% ([Exhibit 14](#)).

2. Will growth continue in non-M&A advisory? We expect structural growth in non-M&A advisory across secondaries and restructuring activity to continue. We view this growth positively, as both secondaries and restructuring dampen IBanks' procyclicality through M&A advisory. We estimate that secondaries + restructuring advisory reached 18% of 2025 total

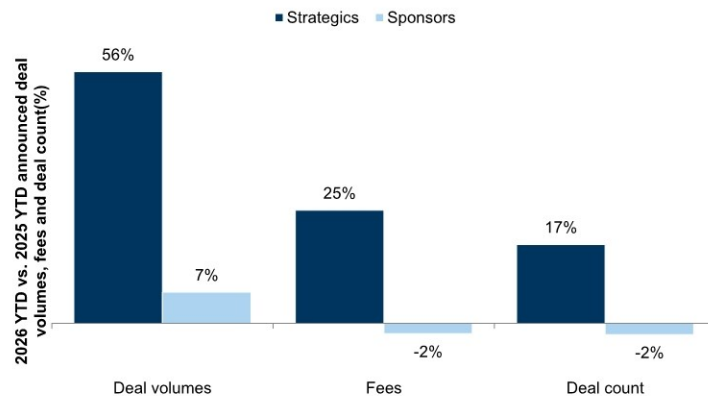
revenue across the IBanks ([Exhibit 15](#)). 1H26 industry secondaries volumes rose a robust 19% YoY ([Exhibit 17](#)), with GP-led volumes comprising the majority of volume share for the first time since 2021, up ~35% growth YoY, while LP-led volumes were largely flat YoY. We expect continued structural growth in secondaries, with industry forecasts prediction 2026 up ~10-15%. We see structural tailwinds, including an increasing number of GPs and LPs viewing secondaries as a tool in the toolkit, as well as cyclical factors, with the current PE backdrop continuing to limit traditional M&A and ECM exits for long-held positions, prompting PE to resort more frequently to alternative capital return methods, such as continuation funds. A recent Secondaries Investor survey indicates that 85%/70% of those surveyed see valuation gaps/asset competition as top reasons impacting the ability to deploy capital ([Exhibit 20](#)). We see pressure from LPs for GPs to return capital continuing to mount, given increasingly aged funds, with our analysis suggesting that 59% of private equity (PE) unrealized value is 5+ years aged, vs. 50% historically ([Exhibit 18](#), [Exhibit 19](#)). On restructuring, we expect elevated activity levels to persist or grow, driven by: 1) mounting debt maturity walls in 2028/29; 2) higher rates, with the forward curve now pricing in 1.5 rate hikes by the end of 2027, vs. 2 cuts as of the beginning of the year; 3) increasing bankruptcy filings; and 4) a bifurcated impact from technological disruption from AI, e.g., in software. We observe that restructuring revenue has a 58% positive R-squared to the absolute level of Fed funds ([Exhibit 21](#), [Exhibit 22](#)). We forecast 2026E restructuring revenue for the group to fall by 2% YoY, and inflect in 2027E, rising 2% YoY. Best positioned: **EVR, PJT** ([Exhibit 60](#))

3. **Mounting questions around structural negative operating leverage, driven by both persistently heavier comp and non-comp spend:** We see structural negative operating leverage across the group. We lowered our 2026E/27E/28E pre-tax margins by 10bps/25bps/20bps vs. pre-EPS, with 2026E pre-tax margins rising only 140bps YoY, and running ~30bps below the 2017-19 average, despite much more scaled IBanks ([Exhibit 26](#), [Exhibit 27](#), [Exhibit 31](#)). We see a further 190bps/120bps of 2027E/28E YoY operating leverage. While this would put 2027E/28E pre-tax margins above the 2017-19 average, it would still be well below prior cyclical peaks, with 2026E/27E/28E 9.3pp/7.3pp/6.1pp below the 2021 peak. We continue to be constructive on mid-cap skewed IBanks on this theme, given more variable compensation structures, due to less reliance on large fixed comp guarantees and deferred stock, vs. in large-cap M&A, as well as better non-comp expense discipline. Best positioned: **LCLN, PIPR**. Further detail on comp and non-comp leverage trends:
 - a. **Structural negative comp leverage across the group**, given the elevated cost of hiring senior bankers. After increasing our 2027E/28E comp ratios by 10bps with earnings, we now model 80bps/90bps/70bps of comp leverage in 2026E/27E/28E ([Exhibit 26](#), [Exhibit 29](#)), with comp ratios of 62.7/61.8%/61.0% that are 225bps/135bps/60bps above 2017-19 averages, and 430bps/340bps/260bps above 2021 peaks. We see comp leverage driven by fixed compensation accounting for 32% of total revenue in 2026E, declining to 30% of total revenue in 2027E, and 29% of revenue in 2028E ([Exhibit 32](#)).
 - b. **Persistently higher than expected non-comp growth**, as 2Q26 non-comp expenses came in 1% above the Street, which, in conjunction with management commentary at 2Q26 EPS, has resulted in Street increasing 2026E

non-comp \$ growth YoY by 3pp, vs. estimates at the beginning of the year. These higher non-comp costs appear to be driven by a combination of greater AI-related and data subscription expenses, and higher travel costs from hiring and elevated oil prices. While we believe AI investments are long-term earnings accretive, ROI on these investments remains unclear, and with investors more closely scrutinizing returns on AI spend, we expect increasing questions on this topic. We raise our 2026E-28E non-comp ratios by 10bps/20bps/10bps ([Exhibit 27](#)).

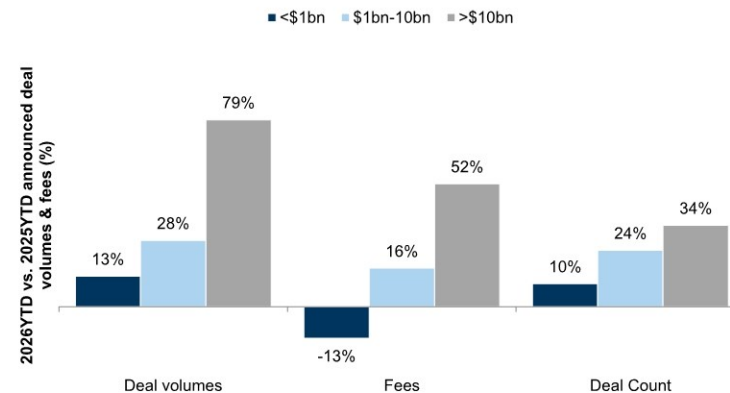
Is strategic/large-cap M&A close to peak levels, and can sponsor/small & mid-cap improve more broadly?

Exhibit 2: 2026 YTD sponsor M&A volumes/fees/deal count are +7%/-2%/-2% YTD YoY, vs. +56%/+25%/+17% for strategics...



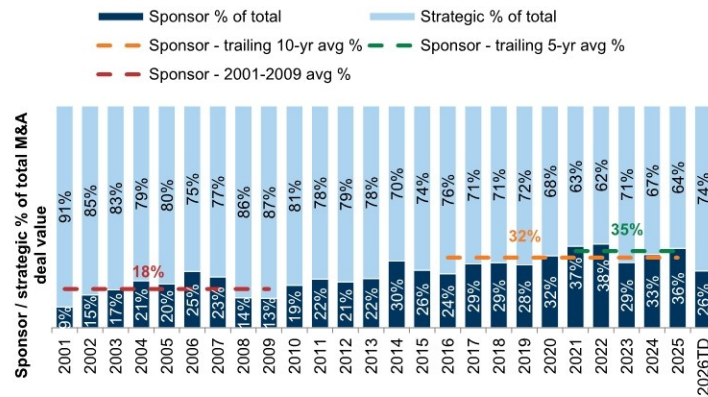
Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: ...and, similarly, YTD announced large-cap M&A volumes are up 79% YoY, vs. small/mid-cap volume up only 13%/28%



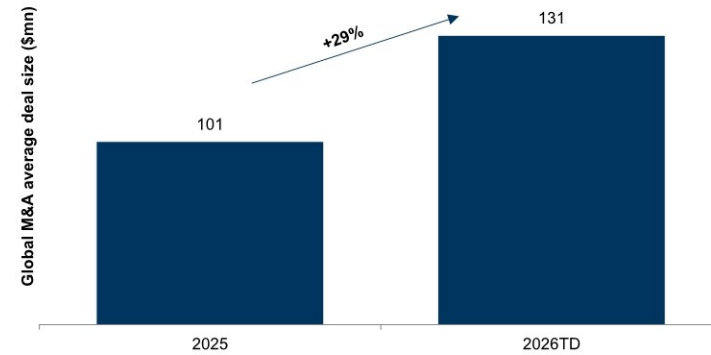
Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Evidencing strategic M&A strength, annual 2026 sponsor M&A volumes comprise only ~26% of the total M&A market, vs. 35%/32% trailing 5-yr/10-yr average...



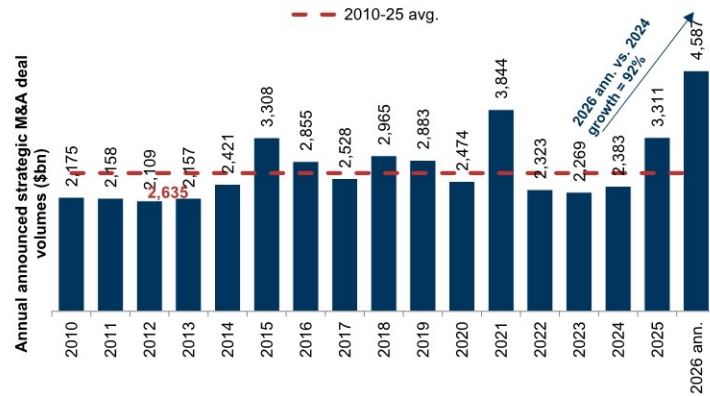
Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: ...and evidencing large two-speed M&A market, the global M&A YTD average deal size is up ~30% YoY

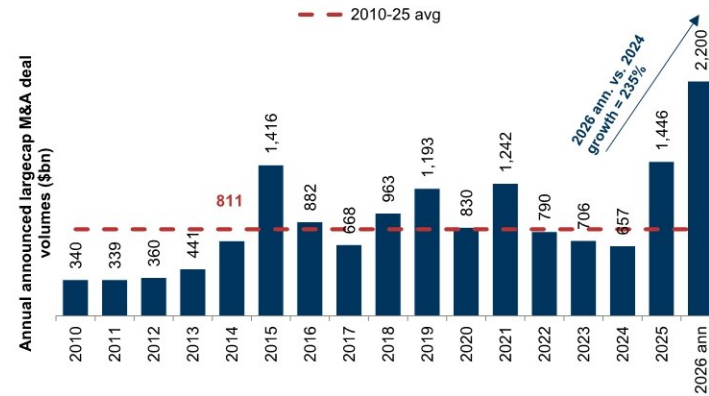


Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Strategic/large-cap M&A

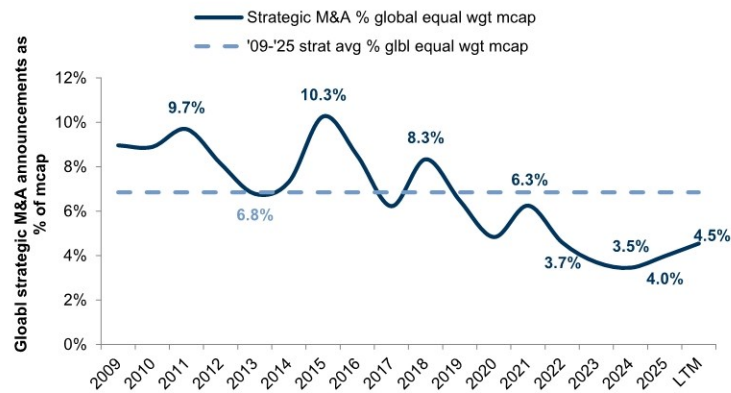
Exhibit 6: Annualized announced strategic M&A volumes have grown 92% from 2024-26 ann...

Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

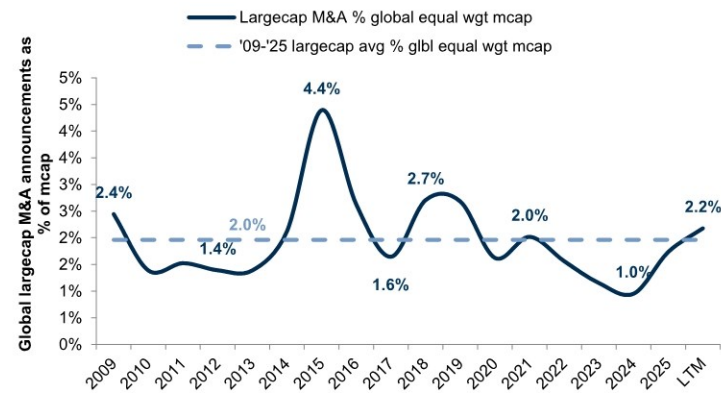
Exhibit 7: ... and annualized announced large-cap M&A volumes have grown 235% from 2024-26 ann...

Note: We consider deals >\$10bn as largecap deals

Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: 2026 Strategic announced volumes are at ~4.5% of equal weight global market cap, below the 6.8% trailing 17-yr avg., but have inflected notably off of the bottom...

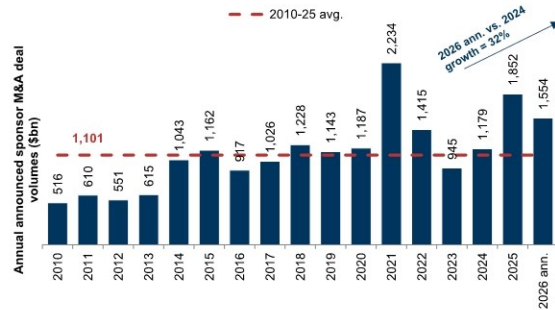
Source: Dealogic, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: ...and 2026 large-cap announced volumes are at 2.2% of equal weight global market cap, above the 2.0% average for the first time since 2019

Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

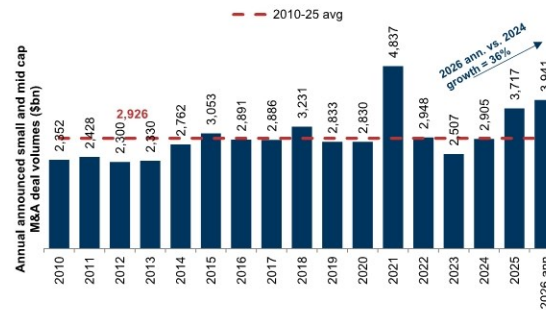
Sponsor/mid-cap M&A

Exhibit 10: Annualized 2026 announced sponsor M&A volumes have grown only 32% since 2024, and are down ~15% YoY in 2026...



Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

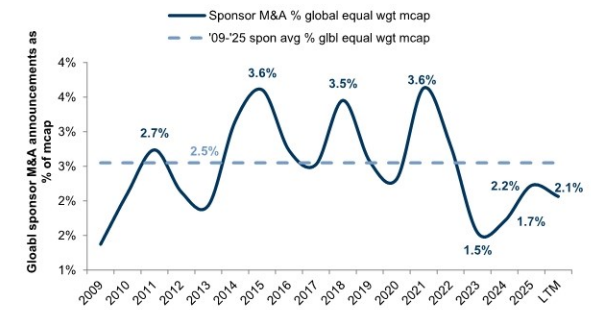
Exhibit 11: ...and announced small & mid-cap M&A volumes have grown 36% from 2024-26



Note: We consider deals <\$10bn as mid and smallcap deals

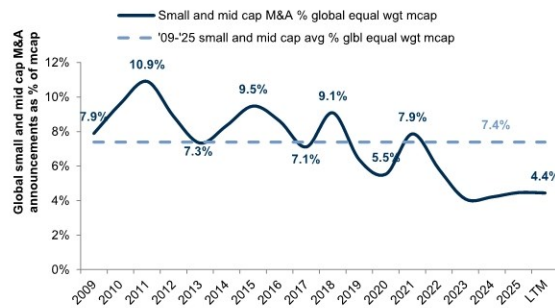
Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: 2026 ann. announced sponsor M&A volumes are at 2.1% of equal weight global market cap, well below 2.5% on average over the past 17 years...



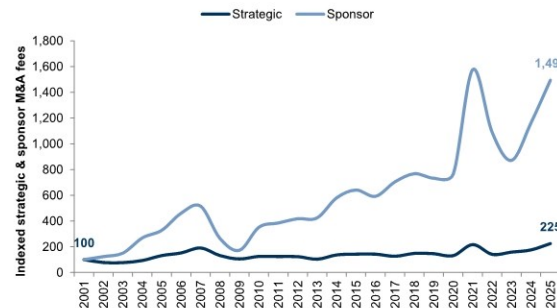
Source: Dealogic, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: ..while small and mid cap deals are at ~4.4% of equal weight market cap, near record lows over the past 17 years



Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

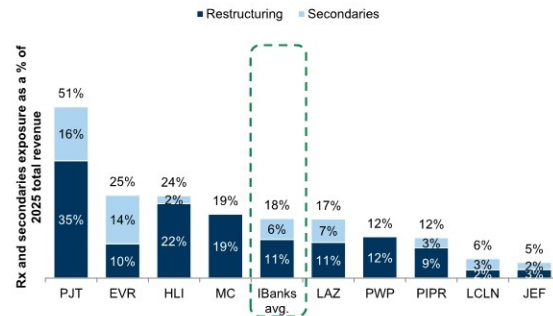
Exhibit 14: Sponsor M&A remains a long-term structural M&A growth area, as fees have increased by 15x since 2001, vs. ~125% for strategics



Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Will growth continue in non-M&A advisory?

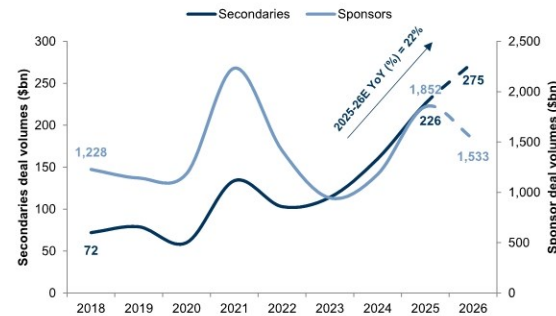
Exhibit 15: We estimate that 18% of IBanks revenue is derived from the combination of secondaries and restructuring revenue



Note: For LCLN, we estimate restructuring is 40% of capital advisory revenue; for peers, due to limited disclosure, restructuring share of advisory revenue is est., except for MC/HLI. We estimate M&A revenue based on TTM M&A share of advisory revenue.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

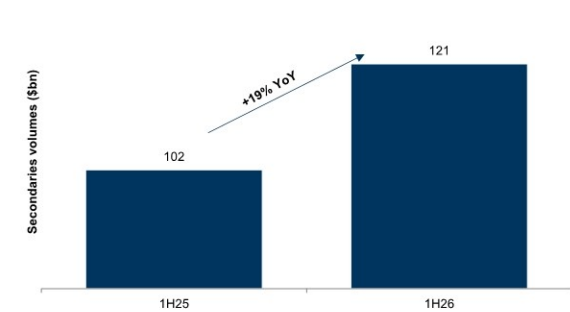
Exhibit 16: While sponsors M&A are projected to decline, secondaries activities remain strong and growing



Note: 2026 sponsor volume is annualized. For 2H26 secondaries volume, Evercore Private Capital Advisory projects \$154bn of fundraising volumes post \$121bn of 1H26 volumes.

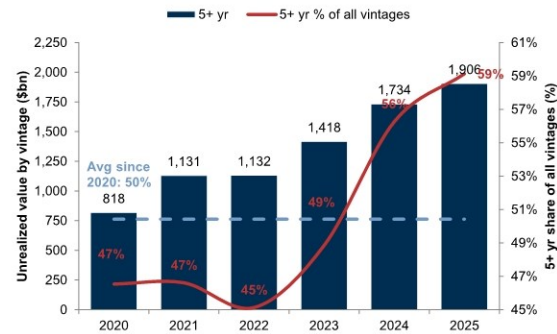
Source: Evercore Private Capital Advisory, Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 17: Secondaries volumes rose 19% YoY in 1H26



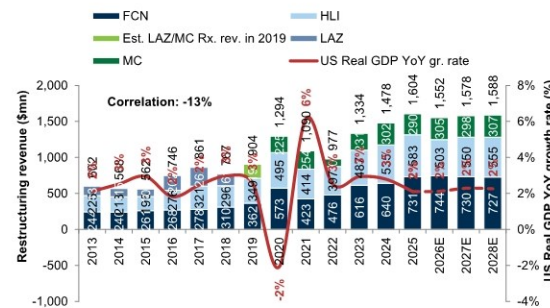
Source: Evercore Private Capital Advisory, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: Buyout funds are substantially more aged than normally, with 59% of unrealized value from 5+ year vintages, above the 50% 5-year average...



Source: Preqin, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

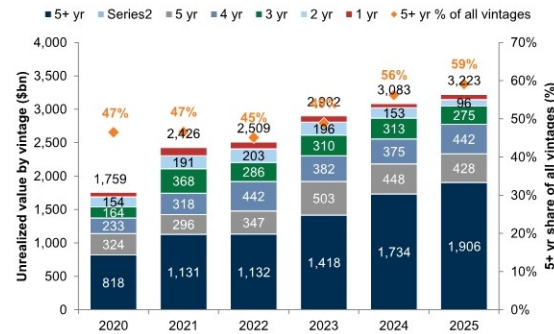
Exhibit 21: IBank restructuring revenue is negatively correlated (-13%) with US GDP growth...



Note: We use LAZ and MC revenue in periods where data is available, and estimate LAZ/MC Rx. revenue in 2019 by taking an average of 2018 LAZ Rx revenue and 2020 MC Rx revenue.

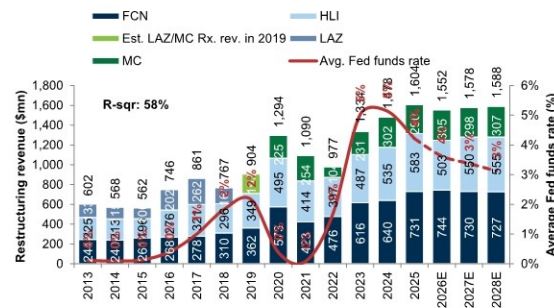
Source: The FRED, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: ...with the absolute \$\$ of 5+ year aged unrealized capital continuing to rise each year since 2020



Source: Preqin, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

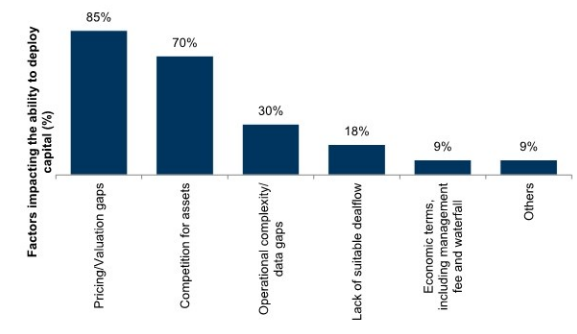
Exhibit 22: ...and positively correlated with the Fed funds rate (58% R-squared)



Note: We use LAZ and MC revenue in periods where data is available, and estimate LAZ/MC Rx. revenue in 2019 by taking an average of 2018 LAZ Rx revenue and 2020 MC Rx revenue.

Source: The FRED, Refinitiv Eikon, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

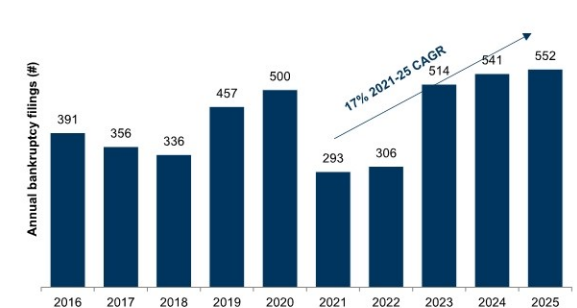
Exhibit 20: Pricing/valuation gaps and asset competition seem to be the top factors affecting capital deployment by sponsors



Note: This survey was conducted by Secondaries Investor with respondents being secondaries buyers only

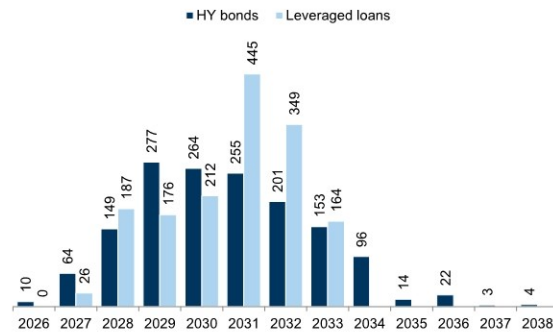
Source: Secondaries Investor Global Market Survey 2026

Exhibit 23: Bankruptcy filings have been on the rise for 4 consecutive years, rising at a 17% CAGR



Source: 2026 Octus Intelligence, PWC

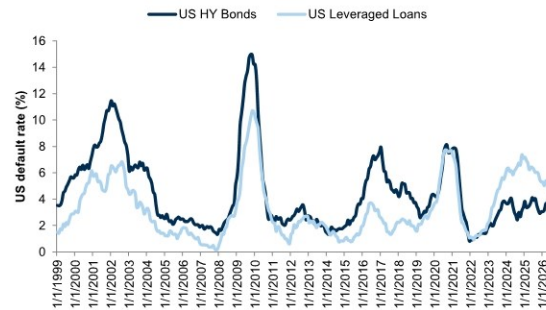
Exhibit 24: US high yield/levered loan maturities continue to rise through 2029E/2028E



Note: Data from GS Credit Strategy

Source: Moody's, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

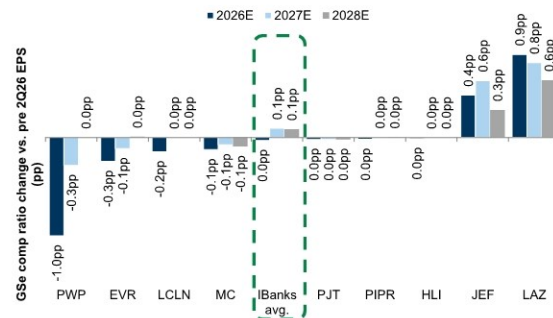
Exhibit 25: GS Credit Strategists forecast US leveraged loans defaults decline in 2026E



Source: Moody's, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

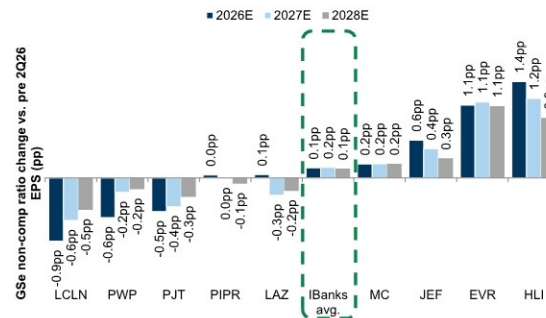
Mounting questions around structural negative operating leverage, driven by both persistently heavier comp and non-comp spend

Exhibit 26: Relative to prior to earnings, we have increased our comp ratio estimates for 2027E/28E by 10bps...



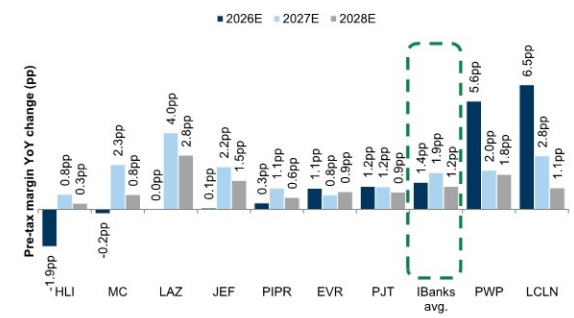
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 27: ...and we have increased our 2026E/27E/28E non-comp ratios by 10bps/20bps/10bps



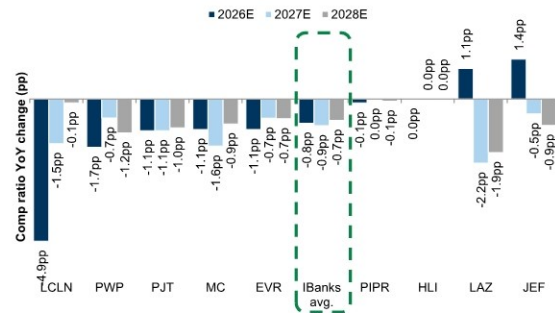
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 28: Across IBanks, we forecast ~140bps/190bps/120bps of YoY pre-tax margin improvement in 2026E/27E/28E...



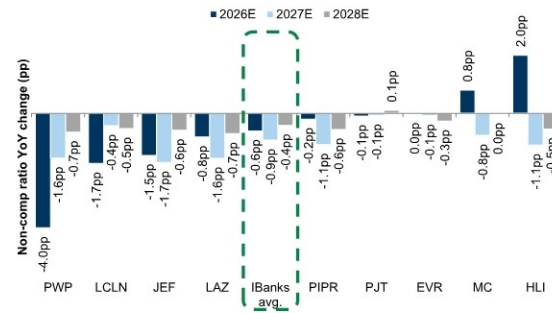
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 29: ...driven by 80bps/90bps/70bps of 2026E/27E/28E YoY comp leverage...



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 30: ...and 60bps/90bps/40bps of 2026E/27E/28E YoY non-comp leverage



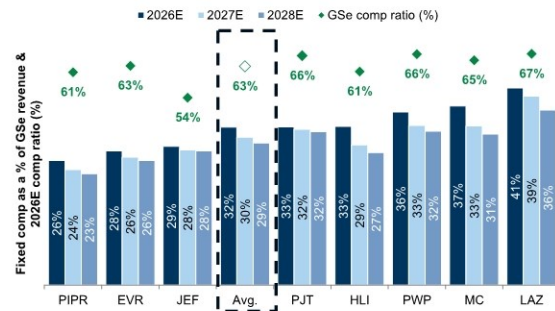
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 31: We estimate 2026E/27E/28E YoY pre-tax margin expansion of ~140bps/190bps/120bps

Advisor & IBank pre-tax margins historicals and GSe forecasts														
(%)	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2017-19 avg.	'26E vs. 17-'19 avg.	'27E vs. 17-'19 avg.	'28E vs. 17-'19 avg.	26E vs. 21
EVR	26.7%	33.8%	25.3%	15.1%	18.0%	21.0%	22.1%	22.9%	23.9%	25.8%	-3.6%	-2.8%	-1.8%	-11.7%
HLI	27.2%	30.6%	24.1%	23.0%	25.1%	26.4%	24.5%	25.2%	25.6%	24.7%	-0.3%	0.5%	0.9%	-6.2%
JEF	20.5%	31.3%	18.7%	8.3%	14.4%	12.5%	12.7%	14.2%	15.8%	14.5%	-1.9%	-0.4%	1.2%	-18.6%
LAZ	20.4%	24.1%	18.7%	3.6%	11.2%	11.4%	11.3%	15.4%	18.2%	23.4%	-12.0%	-8.0%	-5.2%	-12.8%
LCLN	--	--	--	--	11.1%	15.7%	21.4%	24.2%	25.3%	--	--	--	--	--
MC	28.5%	34.3%	22.5%	-2.0%	16.4%	21.5%	21.3%	23.6%	24.4%	25.5%	-4.2%	-1.9%	-1.1%	-13.1%
PIPR	19.5%	27.3%	18.3%	15.6%	19.7%	21.9%	22.2%	23.3%	23.9%	16.3%	5.9%	7.0%	7.6%	-5.1%
PJT	25.7%	24.4%	21.5%	15.8%	18.6%	20.8%	22.0%	23.1%	24.0%	17.6%	4.4%	5.4%	6.3%	-2.4%
PWP	7.3%	22.1%	15.5%	8.5%	15.5%	10.9%	16.5%	18.6%	20.4%	9.5%	7.0%	9.1%	10.9%	-5.6%
Avg.	22.0%	28.5%	20.6%	11.0%	16.7%	18.0%	19.3%	21.2%	22.4%	19.7%	-0.3%	1.5%	2.7%	-9.4%

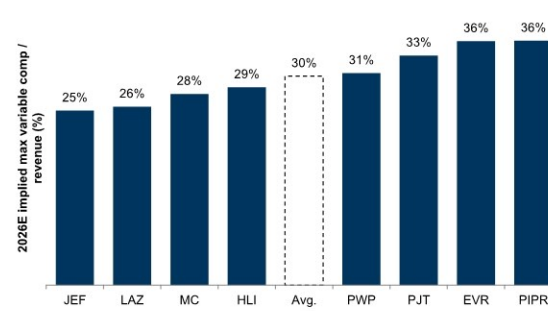
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 32: We estimate fixed comp as a % of GSe revenue at 32%/30%/29% for 2026E/27E/28E



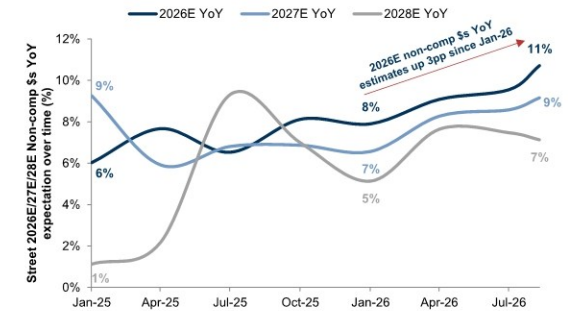
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 33: We estimate max variable comp / revenue at ~30% in 2026E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 34: Non-comp forecasts continue to rise on higher guides; the Street now models +11% 2026E non-comp \$s YoY



Note: HLI is calendarized. For PWP, we assume 2027E non-comp expectations as of Jan-25 to be same as Apr-25 due to data unavailability. For PJT, we assume 2028E non-comp expectations as of Jun-25 and Oct-25 to be same as Apr-25 due to data unavailability. For 2028E non-comp YoY, we exclude PWP due to data unavailability. Data till Aug-26.

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

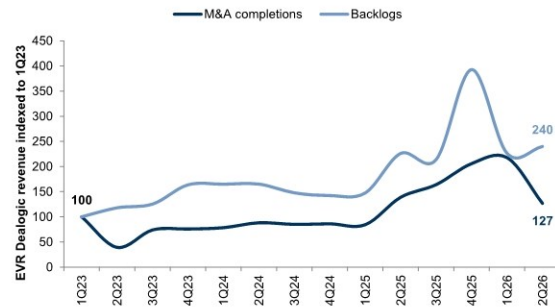
Top picks

- **EVR (Buy, \$377 12-month PT, 23% upside):** EVR remains a best-in-class quality name across the peer group, which we expect to deliver above-average revenue growth and market share gains, as multiyear, robust investments across M&A and other IBanking businesses continue and compound. Overall, we model a 15% 2025-28E revenue CAGR, outpacing 11% for peers on average. We believe that EVR's M&A business skews to areas of the market that are poised to grow more ([Exhibit 37](#)). We see evidence of this in EVR's stronger publicly available Dealogic data compared to IBanks peers, with its YTD completions up by 22% YoY (from an already elevated base), vs. +5% on median across the group ([Exhibit 36](#)). Further, its backlogs remain elevated, up 140% since 1Q23. Finally, EVR has notably diversified its business over the years to a greater degree than peers, which should allow it to perform in a wider range of market backdrops, and make it more of an all-weather firm ([Exhibit 38](#)). For example: 1) secondaries advisory contributed 14% of 2025 revenue for EVR, vs. only 5% for the group ([Exhibit 39](#)). 2) EVR's sponsor business, a key investment area, has reached scale, as it is now middle of the group in terms of % of total firmwide M&A revenue according to Dealogic ([Exhibit 37](#)).
- **LCLN (Buy, \$28.50 12-month PT, 16% upside):** LCLN offers a best-in-class top-line and earnings growth trajectory over the medium term, driven by: 1) its smaller scale supporting more rapid growth; 2) market share gains through organic investment; and 3) inorganic growth upside potential. We forecast a 2025-28E revenue CAGR of 15%, vs. 10% for peers ([Exhibit 40](#)). We forecast organic growth catalyzed by continued senior banker hiring, with a 6% 2025-28E MD CAGR ([Exhibit 41](#)). The company's investments in IBanking Advisory and in Valuations and opinions continue to diversify the business beyond M&A and reduce procyclicality, with M&A representing ~2/3 of 2025 revenue, down from 82% in 2021 ([Exhibit 42](#)). The company has a structurally growing Valuations and opinions business, which benefits from continued alternative asset management AUM growth, as well as increasing frequency of valuations across the industry. Further, the company offers clients access to its aggregated proprietary valuation data, which represents a differentiated client acquisition strategy ([Exhibit 43](#)). LCLN's IBanking advisory revenue benefits from a constructive M&A market backdrop, and leverage to areas of the M&A market we are increasingly more constructive on, namely: 1) the steady growth area of mid-cap M&A; and 2) long-term structural sponsor M&A growth. Strong top-line growth supports best-in-class margin expansion, with LCLN's normalized pre-tax margins forecasted to rise ~7.5pp from 2025-28E, vs. only ~3pp for peers ([Exhibit 44](#)).
- **PIPR (Buy, \$93 12-month PT, 24% upside):** PIPR offers a healthy through-the-cycle earnings growth trajectory, underpinned by a diversified model across healthcare and financials corporate finance, acyclical trading, and downside protection from a less volatile comp ratio. PIPR's M&A/DCM revenue is skewed towards Financials (34%/69%), in which we see idiosyncratic upside tied to the improving financials regulatory backdrop. PIPR's trading revenue provides an acyclical hedge, growing steadily at a 7% CAGR between 2011-25, with no significant downside in times of macro weakness, given the inventory-light model, meaning that volumes are driven more by volatility, often prevalent in

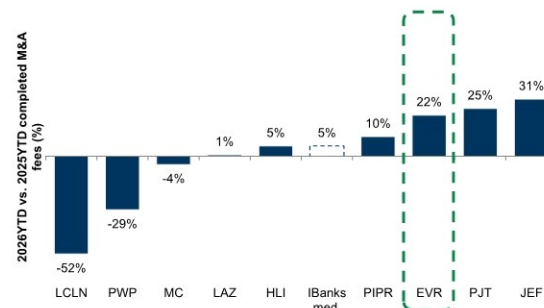
uncertain macro backdrops ([Exhibit 46](#)). We expect higher and more stable margins (a ~22% 2026E pre-tax margin, vs. ~16% for peers on average) and less negative structural operating leverage, reflecting a more variable comp model, with less fixed comp burden (we estimate 26% fixed comp as a percent of 2026E revenue, vs. 33% for peers), and superior non-comp expense management. PIPR trades at a ~14.5x GSe NTM P/E (a ~75th percentile level over the past decade), and we continue to see further rerating potential over time, as the market more fully discounts PIPR's through-the-cycle model.

- **PJT (Buy, \$203 12-month PT, 18% upside):** PJT offers a unique through-the-cycle, structural growth profile, with best-in-class exposure to large-cap strategic M&A, restructuring and secondaries, the latter two of which we remain constructive on, and offer downside protection in a more challenging macro and geopolitical backdrop. We estimate 35%/16% of the company's 2025 revenue derived from countercyclical restructuring/structural growth secondaries (vs. 9%/5% for peers), and the company has best-in-class skew to large-cap and strategic M&A at 48%/73% of revenue, vs. 26%/50% for the group. Further, PJT is the only one of the scaled IBanks exposed to large cap M&A (i.e., EVR, LAZ, MC, PJT) that has delivered positive structural operating leverage vs. the 2017-19 period, which we expect to continue. We believe that, as the market continues to discount these earnings drivers, as well as PJT's lower net income volatility and smaller earnings surprises, relative to peers, this could prompt further relative rerating ([Exhibit 50](#)).

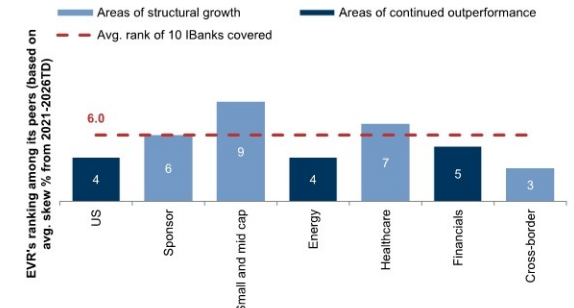
EVR

Exhibit 35: EVR M&A completions/backlogs have grown by ~25%/140% since 1Q23...

Source: Dealogic, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 36: ...with its completions up ~22% YoY YTD, vs. +5% for the group

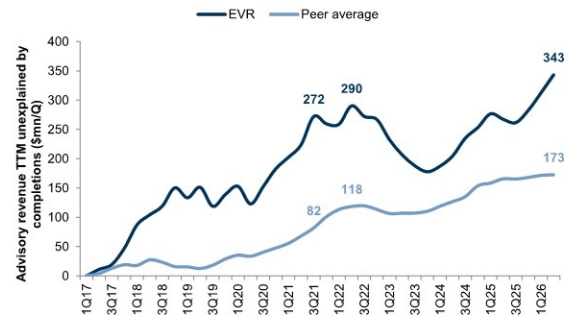
Source: Dealogic, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 37: EVR has strong skew to areas of the M&A cycle we prefer (strategics, large-caps), and those with structural growth going forward like cross-border...

Note: Ranking is based on avg. revenue skew from 2020-2026 TD (1 is best, 10 is worst).

Source: Dealogic, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

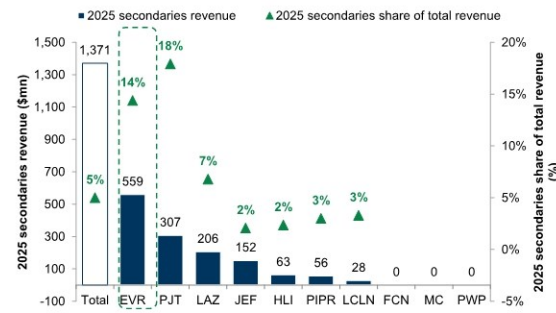
Exhibit 38: ...and has diversified its revenue mix into non-M&A streams more than peers



Note: Data till 2Q26.

Source: Dealogic, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

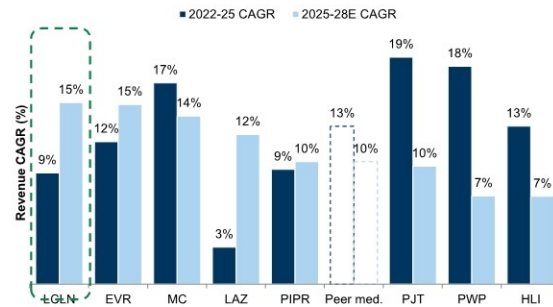
Exhibit 39: EVR's 2025 secondaries revenue comprised 14% of revenue, vs. 5% across the group



Note: PIPR 2024 total secondaries revenue is calculated for Aviditi Advisors. We assume a revenue of \$1mn/employee for 47 disclosed employees in line with company productivity. We assume 51%/34% 2025 YoY growth rate, and a 15% 2026 YoY growth rate for GP/LP-led deal volumes. For LCLN, we estimate 50% of Private Funds Advisory revenue to be attributable to secondaries.

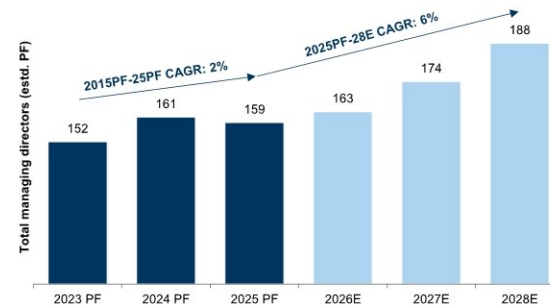
Source: Evercore estimates, Lazard estimates, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

LCLN

Exhibit 40: Our 15% 2025-28E revenue CAGR compares to 10% for peers

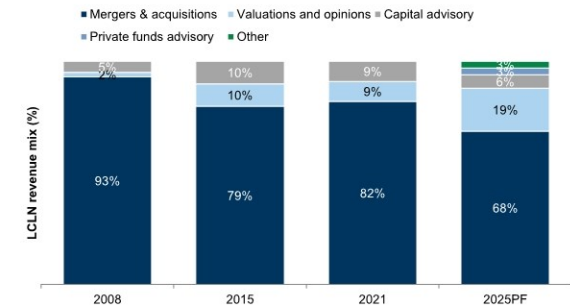
Note: LCLN pro-forma for MarshBerry acquisition (closed in September 2025); for PWP, use 2022-24/2024-28E CAGR/delta.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 41: We forecast 6% p.a. growth in total MDs from 2025-28E

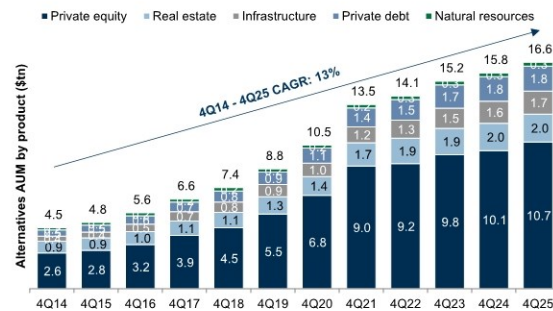
We estimate 2023 pro-forma MD count.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

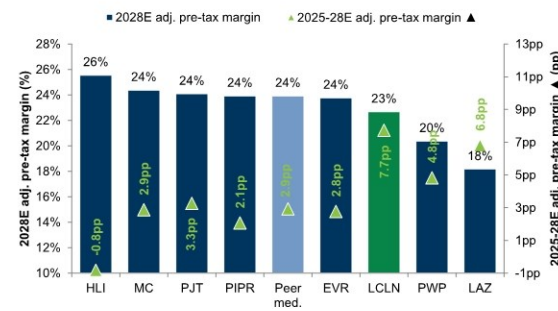
Exhibit 42: In 2025 (pro forma), M&A comprised 68% of LCLN's revenue, vs. 82% in 2021

Note: 2025 is pro forma for the MarshBerry acquisition; M&A incorporates MarshBerry's M&A-related client revenue and Other incorporates FirstChoice, Connect and consulting client revenue.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

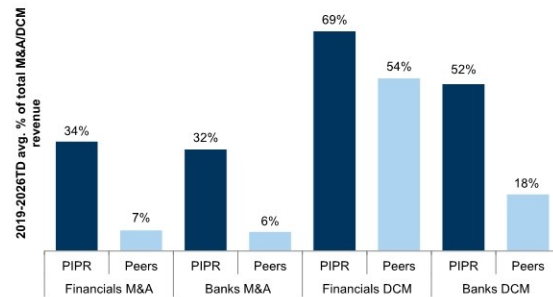
Exhibit 43: Valuations & opinions revenue should be supported by structural Alternatives AUM growth of 13% per annum from 2014-25

Source: Preqin, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

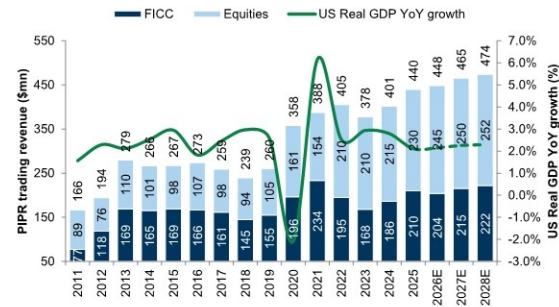
Exhibit 44: We estimate LCLN's normalized pre-tax margin increases ~7.5pp from 2025-28E to 23%, vs. +3pp for peers

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

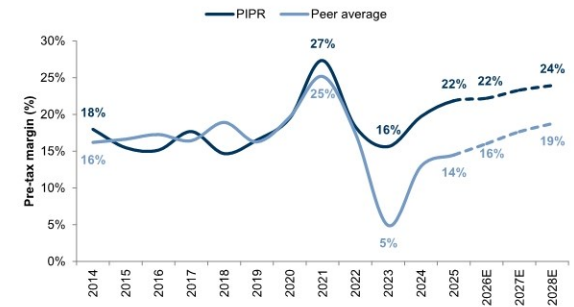
PIPR

Exhibit 45: PIPR offers unique financial services and bank M&A / DCM skew

Source: Dealogic, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

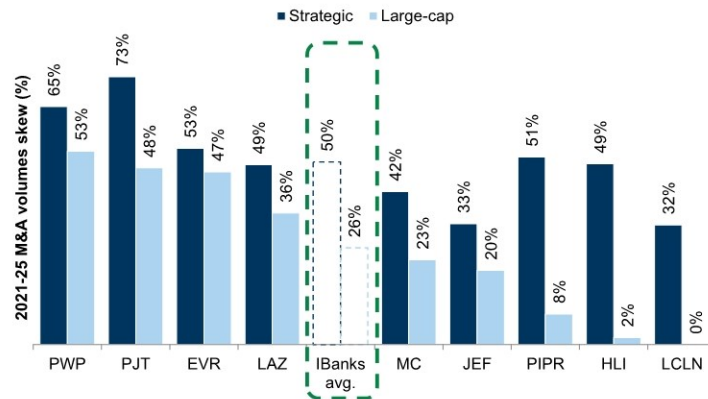
Exhibit 46: PIPR has delivered steady trading revenue across economic cycles

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

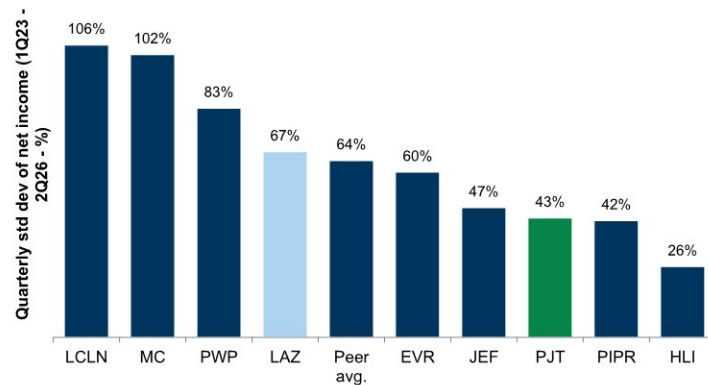
Exhibit 47: We expect PIPR's 2028E pre-tax margin to be 5pp above peers', and for it to exhibit less margin vol. than peers, driven by a less volatile comp ratio

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

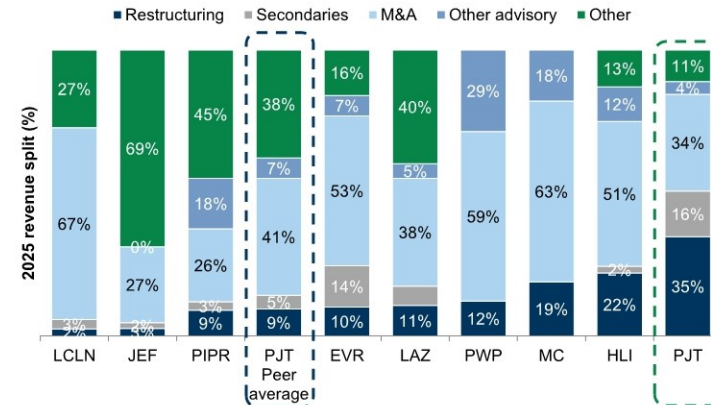
PJT

Exhibit 48: PJT has the highest exposure to strategic M&A in the group, and the 2nd most large-cap M&A exposure

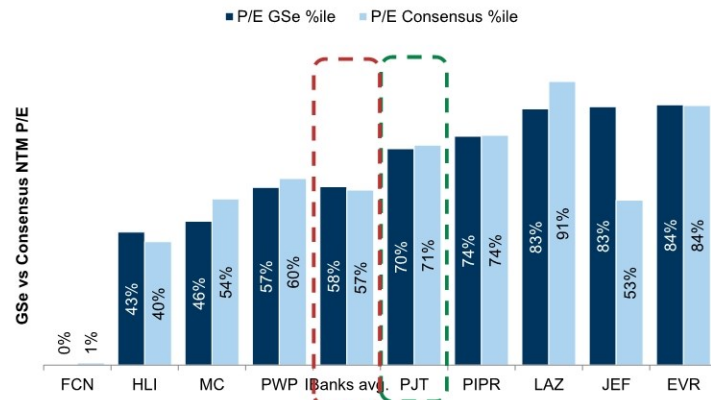
Source: Dealogic, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 50: PJT has among the lowest net income volatility across the peers

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 49: ~50% of PJT's revenue is estimated to be comprised of countercyclical restructuring and structural growth secondaries businesses, vs. 14% for peers

Source: Secondaries Investor, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

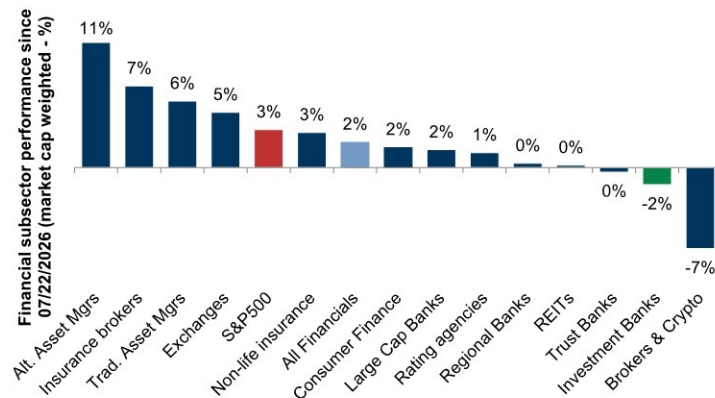
Exhibit 51: PJT currently trades at ~70th %ile GSe/cons. NTM P/E multiple over the past decade, vs. the ~60th/55th %ile for the group

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, FactSet, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and new vs. old

Our investment bank stocks declined 2% on average since the day before first 2Q26 IBank EPS print (07/22/2026)³, underperforming the S&P 500 by 5pp, driven largely estimate downgrades, as the market factors in concerns around an air pocket in 2H26, a 1% 2Q26 EPS miss, continued geopolitical concerns, and notably uneven deal activity trends across components of IBanking, though somewhat offset by a still strong M&A cycle. In our view, current valuation offers modest potential upside, given the strength of the IBanking backdrop. The group trades at ~16.0x/15.5x GSe/consensus NTM P/E, or ~60th/55th %ile P/E multiples over the past decade (Exhibit 56).

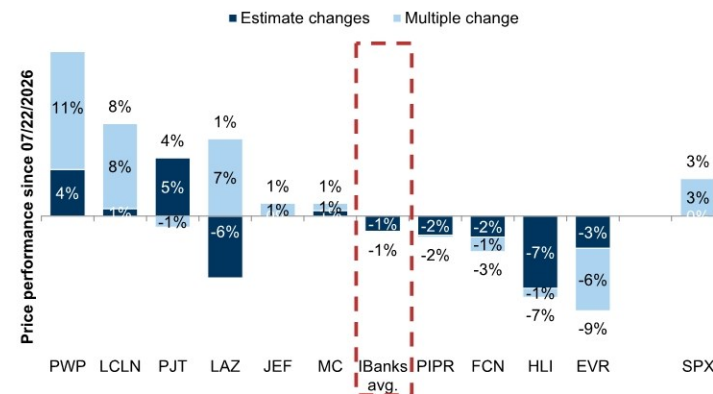
Exhibit 52: IBanks have underperformed the broader market by 5pp since 07/22/2026



Note: We have considered market capital weighted price performance for each group.

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

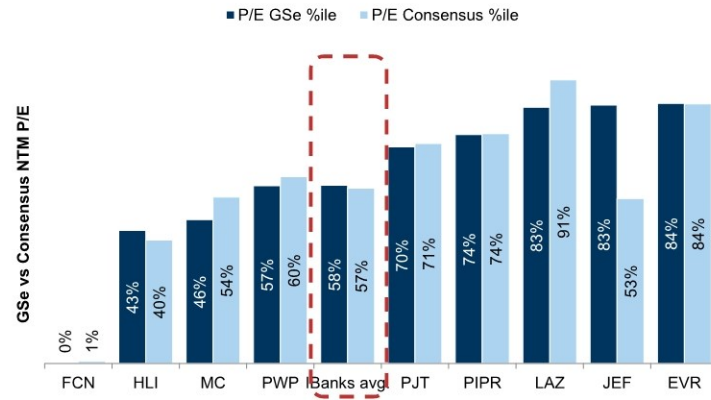
Exhibit 53: ...with performance driven largely by estimate downgrades



Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

³ Excluding JEF which has a fiscal year different from calendar year.

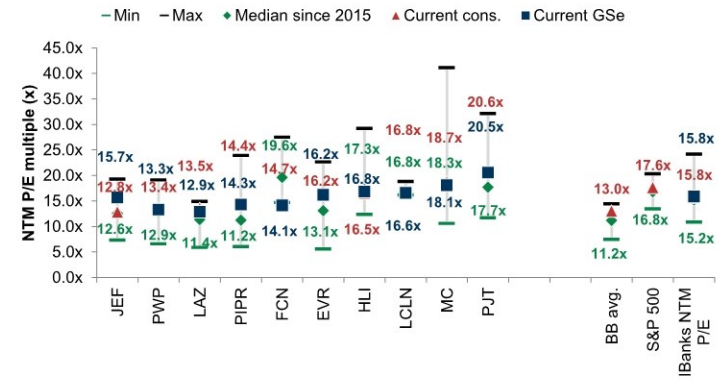
Exhibit 54: IBanks currently trade at ~60th/55th %ile GSe/cons. NTM P/E multiples over the past decade



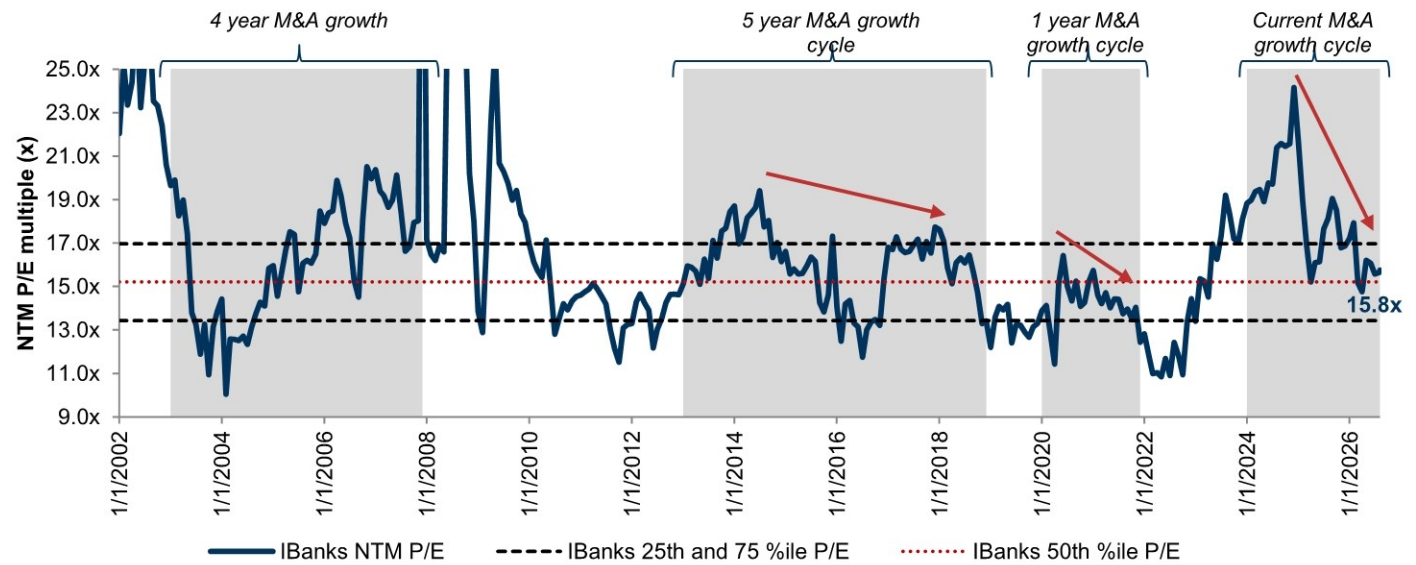
Note: We use NTM P/E for consensus, for all the latest months data is available from vendor, before which we use NTM rolling days P/E. We exclude LCLN to calculate %ile given a short time period since its IPO.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Exhibit 55: Comparing P/E for the group and peers



Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 56: IBanks trade at modestly higher than 50th %ile NTM P/Es of ~16.0x

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

New vs. old:

Based on updated Dealogic data for the quarter, and the macro & geopolitical backdrop, we hold our 2026E/27E/28E IBank earnings estimates unchanged, with dispersion in EPS estimate changes largely driven by differences in business mix and Dealogic trends. We increase our target Q5-Q8 P/E multiples by 0.3x to account for higher market multiples, with our 12-month price targets increasing by 2% on average (Exhibit 57). We now project an upside of 13% and a dividend yield of 3%, resulting in an average total return of 15%.

Exhibit 57: Old vs. new estimates and price targets

Ticker	Price 8/9/26	Analyst	Old Estimates								New Estimates								New vs Old Estimates								Return		
			Rating	PT	Target P/E	EPS					Rating	PT	Target P/E	EPS					EPS					P/E (New vs. old)	PTs	Upside	Div	Total	
					Q5-Q8	3Q26E	Q5-Q8	2026E	2027E	2028E			Q5-Q8	3Q26E	Q5-Q8	2026E	2027E	2028E	3Q26E	Q5-Q8	2026E	2027E	2028E						
PIPR	\$74.79	Yaro	Buy	\$93.00	15.5x	0.93	6.01	4.66	5.67	6.44	Buy	\$93.00	15.5x	0.93	6.01	4.66	5.67	6.44	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0.0x	0%	24%	3%	27%	
EVR	\$305.94	Yaro	Buy	\$376.00	16.0x	3.39	23.51	19.83	21.73	25.26	Buy	\$377.00	16.0x	3.33	23.58	19.78	21.82	25.37	-2%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0.0x	0%	23%	1%	25%	
PJT	\$171.34	Yaro	Buy	\$200.00	21.0x	1.86	9.50	8.01	9.03	10.10	Buy	\$203.00	21.0x	1.86	9.65	8.01	9.17	10.26	0%	2%	0%	2%	2%	0.0x	1%	18%	1%	19%	
HLI	\$129.00	Yaro	Buy	\$148.00	17.5x	1.72	8.47	6.64	8.16	9.10	Buy	\$152.00	18.0x	1.72	8.45	6.64	8.15	9.08	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0.5x	3%	18%	3%	20%	
LCLN	\$24.55	Yaro	Buy	\$28.00	16.5x	0.27	1.68	1.29	1.59	1.87	Buy	\$28.50	17.0x	0.27	1.68	1.29	1.59	1.87	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0.5x	2%	16%	2%	18%	
JEF	\$56.62	Yaro	Buy	\$64.00	13.0x	0.92	4.91	3.32	4.39	5.26	Buy	\$65.00	13.5x	0.90	4.82	3.25	4.24	5.20	-2%	-2%	-2%	-3%	-1%	0.5x	2%	15%	3%	18%	
FCN	\$151.43	Yaro	Neutral	\$172.00	15.0x	2.49	11.45	9.34	10.81	12.28	Neutral	\$171.00	15.0x	2.58	11.42	9.40	10.76	12.25	4%	0%	1%	0%	0%	0.0x	-1%	13%	0%	13%	
MC	\$66.63	Yaro	Neutral	\$69.00	16.0x	0.80	4.29	3.17	4.08	4.54	Neutral	\$71.00	16.5x	0.80	4.31	3.18	4.09	4.57	1%	0%	0%	0%	1%	0.5x	3%	7%	5%	12%	
PWP	\$17.50	Yaro	Sell	\$16.00	11.0x	0.36	1.47	1.02	1.38	1.73	Sell	\$17.00	11.5x	0.36	1.47	1.02	1.38	1.73	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0.5x	6%	-3%	2%	-1%	
LAZ	\$44.20	Yaro	Sell	\$40.00	9.0x	0.69	4.44	2.51	3.93	5.08	Sell	\$42.00	9.5x	0.70	4.47	2.54	3.95	5.14	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0.5x	5%	-5%	5%	0%	
Avg.	--	--	--	--	15.1x	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	15.4x	--	--	--	--	--	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0.3x	2%	13%	3%	15%	

Note: HLI estimates are calendarized as they report March fiscal year end; Our 12m price target is based on Q5-Q8 earnings; LCLN EPS is normalized adj. EPS.

Source: FactSet, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 58: Key risks

Ticker	Rating	12m Price Target	Risks	
			Downside	Upside
PIPR	Buy	\$93.00	Slower than expected growth in IBanking and trading; weaker M&A backlogs; longer time to completion pushing out both M&A and restructuring revenue; giving up prior market share gains; large cash build up dragging on returns	NA
EVR	Buy	\$377.00	Weaker M&A backlogs, translating into weaker revenue expectations; longer time to completions pushing out both M&A and restructuring revenue; higher compensation expense pressuring pre-tax margins; longer-term share losses through slower market/vertical expansion than competitors.	NA
PJT	Buy	\$203.00	Weaker M&A backlogs, translating into weaker revenue expectations; longer time to completions pushing out both M&A and restructuring revenue; slower scaling of business means revenue growth disappoints; inability to drive margin catch-up; longer-term share losses through slower market/vertical expansion than competitors	NA
HLI	Buy	\$152.00	Slower M&A activity; inability to complete backlog; large M&A deals continue to outperform; GCA Corp integration does not go as planned	NA
LCLN	Buy	\$28.50	Slower M&A activity; continued slowdown in mid-cap & sponsor M&A activity; longer time for successful acquisition integration	NA
JEF	Buy	\$65.00	Larger-than-expected normalization in trading revenue, a recession in the US that could weigh notably on investment banking and asset management results, and a much longer time frame to wind down the merchant bank.	NA
FCN	Neutral	\$171.00	Large-cap M&A and restructuring remaining weak, while small-cap M&A accelerates and utilization falls across businesses.	Restructuring accelerates significantly faster at the same time as small-cap M&A weakens; much larger share repurchases; utilization in F&LC improves dramatically
MC	Neutral	\$71.00	Potential pressure on margin due to lower completions; greater normalization of sponsor M&A	Better-than-expected M&A announcements especially in sponsors drive higher than expected margin; much larger capital return
PWP	Sell	\$17.00	NA	M&A accelerates more quickly than anticipated; large-cap and strategic M&A activity continue to outperform, generates growth and hiring without pressuring the comp ratio as much.
LAZ	Sell	\$42.00	NA	Better than expected EU M&A announcements, spin-off/sale of AM business. Increase in asset management AUM, less AUM fee pressure and stronger emerging market performance. Larger capital returns.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Appendix

Exhibit 59: Secondaries revenue sizing analysis

IBanks' secondaries analysis								
(\$mn / %)	EVR	JEF	LAZ	PIPR	PJT	HLI	Total	Key
2023 secondaries revenue								
2023 secondaries GP deal volume (\$bn)	13.0	3.9	7.9		14.7		40	A
GP deal fees rate	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%		0.9%		0.9%	B
2023 secondaries GP fees (\$mn)	130.0	39.5	78.8		125.0		373	C = A * B
2023 secondaries LP deal volume (\$bn)	14.0	12.3	3.9		15.3		45	D
LP deal fees rate	0.20%	0.20%	0.20%		0.20%		0.20%	E
2023 secondaries LP fees (\$mn)	28	25	8		31		91	F = D * E
2023 secondaries total deal volume	27	16	12		30		85	G = A + D
2023 secondaries blended fee rate	0.59%	0.39%	0.73%		0.52%		0.55%	H = I / G
Total secondaries revenue (\$mn)	158.0	64.0	86.6		155.6		464	I = C + F
as % of 2023 revenue	6%	1%	4%		13%		3%	J = I / revenue
as % of 2023 advisory revenue	8%	5%	6%		13%		6%	K = I / advisory revenue
2024 secondaries revenue								
2024 secondaries GP deal volume (\$bn)	28.8	7.4	12.4		21.0	3.7	73	L
GP deal fees rate	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%		0.9%	1.0%	1.0%	M
2024 secondaries GP fees (\$mn)	288.0	74.0	124.4		178.5	37.0	702	N = L * M
2024 secondaries LP deal volume (\$bn)	31.2	15.0	6.8		14.0	2.5	70	O
LP deal fees rate	0.20%	0.20%	0.20%		0.20%	0.20%	0.20%	P
2024 secondaries LP fees (\$mn)	62	30	14		28	5	139	Q = O * P
2024 secondaries total deal volume	60	22	19		35	6	143	R = L + O
2024 secondaries blended fee rate	0.58%	0.46%	0.72%		0.59%	0.68%	0.62%	S = T / R
Total secondaries revenue (\$mn)	350	104	138	47	207	42	888	T = N + Q
as % of 2024 revenue	12%	1%	5%	3%	14%	2%	5%	U = T / revenue
as % of 2024 advisory revenue	14%	6%	8%	6%	14%	2%	8%	V = T / advisory revenue
2025 secondaries revenue (Assumption: GP-led volumes grow by 51% YoY and LP-led volumes grow by 34% YoY)								
2025E secondaries GP deal volume (\$bn)	44.6	11.2	18.8		31.7	5.6	112	W = L * 1.55
GP deal fees rate	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%		0.9%	1.0%	1.0%	X
2025E secondaries GP fees (\$mn)	445.5	111.7	187.8		269.5	55.9	1,070	Y = W * X
2025E secondaries LP deal volume (\$bn)	56.7	20.1	9.1		18.8	3.4	108	Z = O * 1.40
LP deal fees rate	0.20%	0.20%	0.20%		0.20%	0.20%	0.20%	AA
2025E secondaries LP fees (\$mn)	113	40	18		38	7	216	AB = Z * AA
2025E secondaries total deal volume	101	31	28		50	9	220	AC = W + Z
2025E secondaries blended fee rate	0.55%	0.49%	0.74%		0.61%	0.70%	0.61%	AD = AE / AC
Total secondaries revenue (\$mn)	559	152	206	56	307	63	1,343	AE = Y + AB
as % of 2025 revenue	14%	2%	7%	3%	18%	2%	7%	AF = AE / revenue
as % of 2025 advisory revenue	17%	7%	11%	5%	18%	2%	11%	AG = AE / advisory revenue
2026E secondaries revenue (Assumption: GP and LP-led volumes grow by 15%)								
2026E secondaries GP deal volume (\$bn)	51.2	12.9	21.6		36.5	6.4	129	AH
GP deal fees rate	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%		0.9%	1.0%	1.0%	AI
2026E secondaries GP fees (\$mn)	512.3	128.5	216.0		310.0	64.3	1,231	AJ = AH * AI
2026E secondaries LP deal volume (\$bn)	65.2	23.1	10.5		21.6	3.9	124	AK
LP deal fees rate	0.20%	0.20%	0.20%		0.20%	0.20%	0.20%	AL
2026E secondaries LP fees (\$mn)	130	46	21		43	8	249	AM = AK * AL
2026E secondaries total deal volume	116	36	32		58	10	253	AN = AH + AK
2026E secondaries blended fee rate	0.55%	0.49%	0.74%		0.61%	0.70%	0.61%	AO = AP / AN
Total secondaries revenue	642.7	174.7	237.0	61.1	353.1	72.0	1,541	AP = AJ + AM
as % of 2026E revenue	13%	2%	7%	3%	19%	3%	7%	AQ = AP / revenue
as % of 2026E advisory revenue	15%	7%	12%	5%	19%	3%	11%	AR = AP / advisory revenue

Source: Evercore Private Capital Advisory, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 60: We forecast 2026E restructuring revenue declines by 2% YoY, after 6% YoY growth in 2025

Ability of restructuring to offset M&A												
Restructuring cycle	FCN	LAZ	HLI	MC	EVR	PJT	PIPR	JEF	PWP	Avg.	Key	
2023 Rx rev.	616	240	487	231	237	548	43	10	79	-	A	
2024 Rx rev.	640	275	535	302	272	629	49	12	91	-	B = A * (1 + C)	
YoY % increase	4%	15%	10%	31%	15%	15%	15%	15%	15%	15%	C = B / A - 1 (HLI, FCN, MC GSe)	
Est. 2024 Rx % of corp finance/advisory/total rev.	75%	16%	24%	25%	11%	42%	6%	10%	10%	24%	D = B / 2024 total GSe revenue	
2024E \$ below est. peak restructuring scenario	-254	-72	-171	-33	-71	-165	-13	-3	-24	-	E = min(B - GSe peak rev., 0)	
2025 Rx rev.	731	293	583	290	289	669	52	12	96	-	F = B * (1 + G)	
YoY % increase	14%	6%	9%	-4%	6%	6%	6%	6%	6%	6%	G = F / B - 1 (HLI, FCN, MC GSe, others using avg.)	
Est. 2025 Rx % of corp finance/advisory/total rev.	78%	16%	22%	19%	9%	39%	5%	11%	13%	23%	H = F / 2025E total GSe revenue	
2025 \$ below est. peak restructuring scenario	-162	-55	-124	-46	-54	-126	-10	-2	-18	-	I = min(F - GSe peak rev., 0)	
2026E Rx rev.	744	286	503	304	282	653	51	12	94	-	K = F * (1 + L)	
YoY % increase	2%	-2%	-14%	5%	-2%	-2%	-2%	-2%	-2%	-2%	L = K / F - 1 (HLI, FCN, MC GSe, others using avg.)	
Est. 2026E Rx % of corp finance/advisory/total rev.	76%	14%	20%	17%	7%	33%	4%	10%	11%	21%	M = K / 2026E total GSe revenue	
2026E \$ below est. peak restructuring scenario	-150	-62	-203	-31	-61	-141	-11	-3	-20	-	N = min(K - GSe peak rev., 0)	
2027E Rx rev.	730	291	550	298	287	665	52	12	96	-	O = K * (1 + P)	
YoY % increase	-2%	2%	9%	-2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	P = O / K - 1 (HLI, FCN, MC GSe, others using avg.)	
Est. 2027E Rx % of corp finance/advisory/total rev.	74%	12%	19%	14%	6%	32%	4%	11%	9%	20%	Q = O / 2027E total GSe revenue	
2027E \$ below est. peak restructuring scenario	-164	-57	-156	-38	-56	-130	-10	-2	-19	-	R = min(O - GSe peak rev., 0)	
2028E Rx rev.	727	294	555	307	290	673	52	12	97	-	S = O * (1 + T)	
YoY % increase	0%	1%	1%	3%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	T = S / O - 1 (HLI, FCN, MC GSe, others using avg.)	
Est. 2028E Rx % of corp finance/advisory/total rev.	74%	12%	19%	15%	6%	32%	4%	11%	9%	20%	U = O / 2028E total GSe revenue	
2028E \$ below est. peak restructuring scenario	-167	-53	-152	-29	-53	-122	-9	-2	-18	-	V = min(S - GSe peak rev., 0)	
2028E further % growth to reach est. peak restructuring scenario	23%	18%	27%	9%	18%	18%	18%	18%	18%	19%	W = max(GSe peak rev. / S - 1, 0)	

Note: Estimation of Rx revenue in 2024-28E based on average of FCN, MC and HLI growth YoY. We calculate GSe peak revenue using prior upcycle growth rates applied to 2023 Rx revenue. For PJT and PWP, we show Rx as a share of total revenue.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

I, James Yaro, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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Company-specific regulatory disclosures

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	Rating Distribution			Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
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Price target and rating history chart(s)

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Target price history table(s)

Moelis & Co. (MC)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-Jul-26	69.00	68.35
19-May-26	71.00	62.25
30-Apr-26	70.00	65.12
13-Apr-26	66.00	64.60
31-Mar-26	62.00	57.00
12-Mar-26	70.00	51.38
05-Feb-26	80.00	71.68
20-Jan-26	82.00	74.81
05-Jan-26	74.00	74.55
17-Nov-25	71.00	60.62
30-Oct-25	73.00	64.27
14-Oct-25	74.00	67.69
03-Oct-25	80.00	68.27
25-Aug-25	78.00	71.99
25-Jul-25	75.00	70.40
15-Jul-25	70.00	69.53
07-Jul-25	66.00	65.58
15-May-25	63.00	61.07
24-Apr-25	56.00	52.61
14-Apr-25	58.00	52.12
08-Apr-25	59.00	48.86
02-Apr-25	68.00	60.13
13-Mar-25	75.00	58.55
24-Feb-25	86.00	70.41
06-Feb-25	87.00	81.20
14-Jan-25	79.00	72.81
06-Jan-25	78.00	75.46
12-Nov-24	79.00	76.93
23-Oct-24	71.00	68.24
10-Oct-24	69.00	66.73

Houlihan Lokey Inc. (HLI)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-Jul-26	148.00	128.34
06-Jul-26	171.00	142.45
19-May-26	179.00	146.81
07-May-26	177.00	153.50
13-Apr-26	189.00	156.04
31-Mar-26	184.00	143.62
12-Mar-26	210.00	139.87
29-Jan-26	243.00	168.81
20-Jan-26	247.00	189.46
05-Jan-26	237.00	182.60
04-Dec-25	231.00	179.36
17-Nov-25	237.00	173.86
31-Oct-25	241.00	179.08
14-Oct-25	229.00	193.59
03-Oct-25	241.00	201.41
25-Aug-25	231.00	196.35
30-Jul-25	227.00	191.39
15-Jul-25	215.00	190.51
07-Jul-25	211.00	185.42
15-May-25	207.00	180.09
08-May-25	191.00	175.04
14-Apr-25	182.00	155.08
08-Apr-25	178.00	141.59
02-Apr-25	194.00	165.89
13-Mar-25	199.00	156.00
24-Feb-25	208.00	170.68
29-Jan-25	211.00	179.80
14-Jan-25	199.00	168.21
06-Jan-25	206.00	173.23
12-Nov-24	203.00	186.53

Moelis & Co. (MC)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
01-Oct-24	68.00	67.93
10-Sep-24	66.00	63.45
06-Aug-24	64.00	60.82
24-Jul-24	65.00	62.79
11-Jul-24	60.00	60.11
08-Jul-24	59.00	57.78
13-May-24	56.00	55.04
24-Apr-24	57.00	53.99
10-Apr-24	60.00	54.04
02-Apr-24	59.00	55.75
13-Mar-24	58.00	54.36
12-Feb-24	53.00	56.08
08-Feb-24	52.00	55.22
09-Jan-24	48.00	54.69
18-Dec-23	47.00	56.80
03-Nov-23	41.00	43.36
03-Oct-23	43.00	43.65
19-Sep-23	45.00	46.44

Houlihan Lokey Inc. (HLI)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
31-Oct-24	192.00	172.77
10-Oct-24	184.00	164.20
01-Oct-24	175.00	159.59
10-Sep-24	168.00	152.74
06-Aug-24	165.00	146.29
31-Jul-24	167.00	150.25
11-Jul-24	157.00	138.75
08-Jul-24	154.00	134.22
13-May-24	151.00	135.96
08-May-24	152.00	132.89
10-Apr-24	151.00	129.21
02-Apr-24	147.00	128.35
21-Feb-24	146.00	129.88
12-Feb-24	143.00	128.73
02-Feb-24	139.00	126.90
09-Jan-24	135.00	115.15
18-Dec-23	133.00	120.17
30-Nov-23	123.00	107.72
13-Nov-23	120.00	102.75
03-Oct-23	117.00	104.31

FTI Consulting Inc. (FCN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-Jul-26	172.00	164.05
13-Jul-26	164.00	161.62
06-Jul-26	159.00	155.69
19-May-26	169.00	154.64
30-Apr-26	194.00	179.30
13-Apr-26	188.00	179.64
31-Mar-26	182.00	176.77
26-Feb-26	183.00	168.11
20-Jan-26	190.00	178.12
05-Jan-26	179.00	179.06
23-Oct-25	167.00	153.70
14-Oct-25	171.00	157.53
03-Oct-25	181.00	160.00
24-Jul-25	192.00	173.49
15-Jul-25	178.00	163.61
07-Jul-25	173.00	166.00
15-May-25	172.00	165.26
25-Apr-25	174.00	162.68
02-Apr-25	169.00	161.27

Piper Sandler Cos. (PIPR)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-Jul-26	93.00	76.18
06-Jul-26	90.00	72.94
13-Apr-26	97.00	85.54
31-Mar-26	88.00	76.55
12-Mar-26	392.00	69.97
06-Feb-26	461.00	91.10
20-Jan-26	449.00	91.92
05-Jan-26	418.00	91.52
10-Nov-25	386.00	83.82
31-Oct-25	368.00	79.82
14-Oct-25	352.00	86.57
03-Oct-25	368.00	85.43
25-Aug-25	336.00	83.61
01-Aug-25	326.00	77.90
15-Jul-25	304.00	74.30
07-Jul-25	296.00	72.20
15-May-25	286.00	66.37
02-May-25	267.00	62.97
14-Apr-25	250.00	56.29

FTI Consulting Inc. (FCN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
24-Feb-25	168.00	166.03
20-Feb-25	173.00	162.99
14-Jan-25	194.00	197.01
06-Jan-25	207.00	190.19
12-Nov-24	212.00	202.01
24-Oct-24	218.00	201.38
01-Oct-24	239.00	228.81
10-Sep-24	231.00	219.17
26-Jul-24	236.00	225.42
11-Jul-24	231.00	217.92
08-Jul-24	226.00	213.71
25-Apr-24	225.00	215.31
02-Apr-24	219.00	207.31
22-Feb-24	225.00	221.67
09-Jan-24	208.00	195.19
18-Dec-23	207.00	203.64
30-Nov-23	227.00	220.46
13-Nov-23	222.00	221.54
27-Oct-23	217.00	215.95
19-Sep-23	189.00	181.90

Piper Sandler Cos. (PIPR)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
08-Apr-25	243.00	52.70
02-Apr-25	268.00	64.74
13-Mar-25	286.00	63.01
24-Feb-25	321.00	70.05
31-Jan-25	330.00	79.29
14-Jan-25	298.00	73.59
06-Jan-25	317.00	74.38
12-Nov-24	365.00	84.36
25-Oct-24	325.00	70.13
10-Oct-24	324.00	70.79
01-Oct-24	310.00	70.64
10-Sep-24	292.00	64.69
06-Aug-24	283.00	60.77
02-Aug-24	286.00	61.14
11-Jul-24	266.00	60.05
08-Jul-24	258.00	58.06
26-Apr-24	238.00	49.29
10-Apr-24	234.00	48.26
02-Apr-24	233.00	48.90
12-Feb-24	224.00	47.44
02-Feb-24	215.00	47.69
09-Jan-24	201.00	42.25
18-Dec-23	193.00	43.51
30-Nov-23	171.00	38.68
13-Nov-23	167.00	35.64
27-Oct-23	162.00	33.67
03-Oct-23	168.00	35.09
19-Sep-23	174.00	37.58

Evercore Inc. (EVR)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
29-Jul-26	376.00	304.71
06-Jul-26	399.00	355.48
19-May-26	404.00	323.26
29-Apr-26	396.00	324.14
13-Apr-26	374.00	350.54
31-Mar-26	335.00	298.51
12-Mar-26	383.00	267.19
05-Feb-26	447.00	351.14
20-Jan-26	438.00	366.50
05-Jan-26	413.00	364.47
04-Dec-25	373.00	328.30

Lazard Inc. (LAZ)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
23-Jul-26	40.00	43.05
13-Jul-26	38.00	41.10
12-Jun-26	40.00	43.72
19-May-26	45.00	45.40
01-May-26	43.00	45.13
13-Apr-26	45.00	48.24
31-Mar-26	40.00	42.48
12-Mar-26	46.00	40.68
29-Jan-26	53.00	53.79
20-Jan-26	49.00	51.97
05-Jan-26	45.00	50.78

Evercore Inc. (EVR)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
17-Nov-25	365.00	296.49
29-Oct-25	387.00	292.49
14-Oct-25	396.00	319.91
03-Oct-25	410.00	329.06
25-Aug-25	375.00	318.35
30-Jul-25	361.00	310.25
15-Jul-25	327.00	287.00
07-Jul-25	298.00	283.79
15-May-25	266.00	237.27
30-Apr-25	234.00	205.29
14-Apr-25	214.00	181.15
08-Apr-25	215.00	163.77
02-Apr-25	252.00	210.12
13-Mar-25	281.00	193.85
24-Feb-25	321.00	245.62
05-Feb-25	336.00	285.06
14-Jan-25	315.00	266.20
06-Jan-25	332.00	278.86
12-Nov-24	343.00	307.05
23-Oct-24	309.00	257.74
10-Oct-24	298.00	252.89
01-Oct-24	290.00	251.00
10-Sep-24	276.00	233.88
06-Aug-24	246.00	227.28
24-Jul-24	251.00	236.39
11-Jul-24	223.00	225.47
08-Jul-24	215.00	212.64
13-May-24	199.00	195.88
24-Apr-24	201.00	186.59
02-Apr-24	205.00	188.76
12-Feb-24	197.00	183.47
31-Jan-24	185.00	171.73
22-Jan-24	171.00	175.27
09-Jan-24	170.00	168.70
18-Dec-23	169.00	164.81
30-Nov-23	149.00	147.55
13-Nov-23	143.00	139.26
25-Oct-23	134.00	126.39
03-Oct-23	142.00	131.18
19-Sep-23	143.00	144.20
22-Aug-23	140.00	131.27

Lazard Inc. (LAZ)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
23-Oct-25	46.00	49.12
14-Oct-25	45.00	49.68
03-Oct-25	49.00	51.79
25-Aug-25	52.00	56.76
24-Jul-25	50.00	54.61
15-Jul-25	45.00	51.94
07-Jul-25	43.00	49.80
15-May-25	40.00	46.21
25-Apr-25	35.00	38.64
14-Apr-25	34.00	35.58
08-Apr-25	33.00	33.41
02-Apr-25	38.00	45.48
13-Mar-25	42.00	44.93
24-Feb-25	46.00	49.24
30-Jan-25	47.00	55.16
14-Jan-25	44.00	46.89
06-Jan-25	51.00	50.46
12-Nov-24	55.00	56.09
31-Oct-24	51.00	52.99
01-Oct-24	47.00	49.16
10-Sep-24	43.00	46.57
06-Aug-24	40.00	44.28
25-Jul-24	42.00	48.48
11-Jul-24	38.00	41.30
08-Jul-24	39.00	39.82
25-Apr-24	37.00	38.89
10-Apr-24	39.00	39.87
02-Apr-24	40.00	40.30
21-Feb-24	37.00	37.87
12-Feb-24	38.00	38.55
01-Feb-24	36.00	41.07
09-Jan-24	33.00	37.91
18-Dec-23	31.00	34.45
26-Oct-23	28.00	28.47
03-Oct-23	30.00	29.36
19-Sep-23	32.00	32.96

Perella Weinberg Partners (PWP)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
31-Jul-26	16.00	17.65
13-Jul-26	14.50	14.91
06-Jul-26	15.50	17.22
12-Jun-26	16.00	15.66
01-May-26	18.00	20.61
13-Apr-26	19.50	20.96
31-Mar-26	17.50	18.16
12-Mar-26	18.50	16.03
06-Feb-26	21.50	23.26
20-Jan-26	19.00	21.60
04-Dec-25	17.00	18.69
17-Nov-25	18.00	17.37
07-Nov-25	17.50	18.02
14-Oct-25	19.00	19.72
03-Oct-25	20.00	20.94
01-Aug-25	21.00	20.97
15-Jul-25	19.00	19.12
07-Jul-25	18.50	20.21
15-May-25	18.00	18.97
02-May-25	16.00	17.59
08-Apr-25	15.50	15.50
02-Apr-25	18.00	19.48
13-Mar-25	20.00	19.64
07-Feb-25	23.00	24.39
14-Jan-25	21.00	23.31
12-Nov-24	23.00	24.82
08-Nov-24	21.50	24.43
10-Oct-24	19.50	20.11
01-Oct-24	18.00	19.44
06-Aug-24	17.00	16.75
02-Aug-24	16.50	17.85
11-Jul-24	15.50	17.36
08-Jul-24	14.50	15.97
10-Apr-24	13.50	15.65
02-Apr-24	13.00	14.61
12-Feb-24	12.50	13.13
08-Feb-24	12.00	12.49
22-Jan-24	11.00	11.51
09-Jan-24	11.50	11.23
18-Dec-23	14.00	12.49
30-Nov-23	13.00	11.72
07-Nov-23	12.50	10.80

Jefferies Financial Group (JEF)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
25-Jun-26	64.00	52.64
05-Jun-26	66.00	55.69
19-May-26	59.00	51.06
13-Apr-26	54.00	46.21
26-Mar-26	47.00	40.28
12-Mar-26	54.00	36.02
10-Mar-26	61.00	38.66
05-Feb-26	71.00	56.51
20-Jan-26	77.00	61.09
08-Jan-26	71.00	61.05
05-Jan-26	76.00	64.49
16-Dec-25	71.00	61.26
04-Dec-25	67.00	58.82
17-Nov-25	66.00	52.49
27-Oct-25	69.00	56.57
14-Oct-25	74.00	53.82
30-Sep-25	84.00	65.42
16-Sep-25	77.00	66.40
25-Aug-25	72.00	62.14
15-Jul-25	67.00	54.81
07-Jul-25	65.00	55.61
26-Jun-25	63.00	56.09
04-Jun-25	60.00	49.08
15-May-25	62.00	53.41
08-Apr-25	55.00	41.06
02-Apr-25	64.00	55.14
27-Mar-25	67.00	54.35
13-Mar-25	70.00	54.26
05-Mar-25	75.00	60.86
24-Feb-25	79.00	65.17
14-Jan-25	82.00	71.52
09-Jan-25	87.00	80.13
05-Dec-24	86.00	77.99
12-Nov-24	81.00	74.32
10-Oct-24	73.00	63.10
26-Sep-24	70.00	61.15
13-Sep-24	68.00	58.54
10-Sep-24	66.00	56.31
06-Aug-24	61.00	54.13
11-Jul-24	60.00	53.44
08-Jul-24	58.00	51.00
27-Jun-24	54.00	48.92

Perella Weinberg Partners (PWP)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
03-Oct-23	11.50	9.92

Jefferies Financial Group (JEF)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
11-Jun-24	52.00	43.24
17-Mar-24	51.00	43.45
12-Feb-24	46.00	41.39
30-Jan-24	48.00	40.89
22-Jan-24	46.00	40.60
09-Jan-24	47.00	39.86
30-Nov-23	44.00	35.44
13-Nov-23	43.00	33.91
17-Oct-23	41.00	34.18
03-Oct-23	42.00	35.05
28-Sep-23	43.00	36.92
19-Sep-23	41.00	38.23
22-Aug-23	40.00	34.25

PJT Partners (PJT)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
28-Jul-26	200.00	173.23
06-Jul-26	189.00	172.02
19-May-26	190.00	153.80
28-Apr-26	185.00	153.20
13-Apr-26	181.00	156.25
31-Mar-26	170.00	139.72
12-Mar-26	158.00	129.05
03-Feb-26	174.00	160.62
20-Jan-26	197.00	187.36
05-Jan-26	181.00	178.05
04-Dec-25	179.00	170.74
17-Nov-25	186.00	158.86
04-Nov-25	189.00	163.42
14-Oct-25	183.00	175.03
03-Oct-25	190.00	179.51
25-Aug-25	189.00	178.01
29-Jul-25	186.00	177.52
15-Jul-25	180.00	178.76
07-Jul-25	169.00	170.86
15-May-25	161.00	147.28
29-Apr-25	153.00	141.46
08-Apr-25	147.00	125.44
02-Apr-25	156.00	141.74
13-Mar-25	164.00	139.91
24-Feb-25	181.00	159.56
04-Feb-25	182.00	173.77

Lincoln International Inc. (LCLN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
06-Aug-26	28.00	23.41
15-Jun-26	27.50	23.32

PJT Partners (PJT)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
14-Jan-25	159.00	156.50
06-Jan-25	164.00	156.84
12-Nov-24	160.00	159.59
29-Oct-24	146.00	138.67
10-Oct-24	143.00	139.65
01-Oct-24	133.00	133.11
10-Sep-24	128.00	118.79
06-Aug-24	133.00	120.51
30-Jul-24	132.00	130.17
11-Jul-24	115.00	111.48
08-Jul-24	112.00	109.40
02-May-24	108.00	98.46
10-Apr-24	102.00	96.28
02-Apr-24	100.00	94.45
21-Feb-24	105.00	101.36
12-Feb-24	101.00	98.97
06-Feb-24	98.00	96.14
09-Jan-24	99.00	95.77
18-Dec-23	108.00	99.27
30-Nov-23	96.00	90.06
13-Nov-23	95.00	83.03
31-Oct-23	92.00	78.36
03-Oct-23	90.00	77.27

Lincoln International Inc. (LCLN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
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